

[EFRAG SECRETARIAT PAPER FOR PUBLIC EFRAG SR TEG MEETING]

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Significance of the Digital Product Passport for ESRS E5 and correspondence with the Ecodesign for Sustainable Products Regulation Issues Paper

Objective

- 1 This issue paper addresses the synergies between the forthcoming Digital Product Passport (hereafter, 'DPP') specifications – pursuant to Regulation (EU) 2024/1781, the Ecodesign for Sustainable Products Regulation¹ (hereafter, 'ESPR') – and the sustainability reporting requirements of 'ESRS E5 Resource Use and Circular Economy' (hereafter, 'ESRS E5'), pursuant to Directive (EU) 2022/2464, the Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive² (CSRD).
- 2 This paper highlights how future comply efforts under the ESPR, particularly through the information made available via the DPP, may support undertakings in communicating their circular performance through ESRS E5 disclosures. It also examines how current corporate practices in applying ESRS E5 may, in turn, influence the future development and implementation of the DPP.
- 3 Additionally, the paper identifies and analyses the similarities and differences between ESPR and ESRS, with a particular focus on their respective approaches to circular economy definitions and sustainability information requirements (i.e. durability, reparability, etc.).
- 4 The paper is structured as follows:
 - (a) [Policy and legal context](#): this section outlines the broader EU policy and regulatory framework in which the ESPR has developed. It situates the initiative within the EU's circular economy agenda and highlights other relevant legislative and policy

¹ [Regulation \(EU\) 2024/1781 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 13 June 2024 establishing a framework for the setting of ecodesign requirements for sustainable products, amending Directive \(EU\) 2020/1828 and Regulation \(EU\) 2023/1542 and repealing Directive 2009/125/EC](#)

² [Directive \(EU\) 2022/2464 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 14 December 2022 amending Regulation \(EU\) No 537/2014, Directive 2004/109/EC, Directive 2006/43/EC and Directive 2013/34/EU, as regards corporate sustainability reporting](#)

developments shaping the transition towards more sustainable and resource-efficient product systems.

- (b) [The ESPR and the DPP](#): this section provides an in-depth analysis of the regulation, including its timeline, scope, key requirements, and the structure and intended functioning of the Digital Product Passport as a central tool for product-related sustainability information.
- (c) [Correspondence between E ESRS E5 and ESPR](#): this section presents a comparative analysis, supported by a structured table, examining similarities and differences between the DPP and ESRS E5. The comparison covers key aspects such as scope, definitions, data requirements, and reporting logic.
- (d) [Significance of the DPP for ESRS E5 reporting and vice versa](#): the final section discusses the interlinkages between the two frameworks, exploring how the DPP may support and enhance ESRS E5 disclosures, and how existing ESRS E5 reporting practices may inform and potentially influence the future development of the DPP.

(a) Policy and legal context

5 The European Union's transition towards a circular economy has become a central component of its sustainability, industrial, and competitiveness agenda. A cornerstone underpinning this transition is the EU Green Deal, which established the EU's ambition to achieve climate-neutrality by 2050 by transforming the European economy into a more resource efficient, resilient and sustainable system. Of particular importance in the EU policy agenda was the adoption of the second Circular Economy Action Plan³ (2020), which established the strategic vision for integrating circularity across the full life cycle of products: from product design to the retention of resources within the EU economy.

6 Since then, the EU has introduced, or is in the process of introducing, a broad set of legislation measures designed to operationalise these objectives. Some of these initiatives set requirements directly at product level, while others regulate processes, waste streams or materials that are crucial to the transition towards a circular economy. Among the most significant measures are:

- (a) *Ecodesign for Sustainable Products Regulation (EU) 2024/1781*: Aims to significantly improve the sustainability of products placed on the EU market by improving their

³ [COMMUNICATION FROM THE COMMISSION TO THE EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT, THE COUNCIL, THE EUROPEAN ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL COMMITTEE AND THE COMMITTEE OF THE REGIONS A new Circular Economy Action Plan For a cleaner and more competitive Europe](#)

circularity, energy performance, recyclability and durability. The ESPR replaces the Ecodesign Directive 2009/125/EC and establishes a framework for setting eco-design requirements on specific product groups.

- (b) *Right to Repair Directive (EU) 2024/1799*: Aims to promote sustainable consumption by increasing repair and reuse of goods both within and outside the legal guarantee. It sets reparability requirements on manufacturers of certain products, who must be able to repair those products within a reasonable time and for a reasonable price. Manufacturers are also required to make available information on their repair services to consumers in an easily accessible manner.
- (c) *Packaging and Packaging Waste Regulation (EU) 2025/40*: Covers all packaging and packaging waste, setting sustainability and labelling requirements across the lifecycle. The Regulation requires that all packaging must be designed for material recycling and must be able to be collected, sorted and recycled at scale when it becomes waste, whilst also establishing a system of recyclability performance grades.
- (d) *Waste Framework Directive (2008/98/EC)*: Establishes a legal framework for treating waste in the EU, which aims to protect the environment and human health by emphasising the importance of proper waste management, recovery and recycling techniques. The Directive introduces a five-step waste hierarchy and the concept of 'Extended Producer Responsibility'.

7 Moreover, considering the new revised priorities laid out in the Competitiveness Compass (2025), a Circular Economy Act is also expected to be finalised for 2026, aiming to establish a real single market for secondary materials, to leverage fiscal and demand levers and to strengthen industrial alliances and collaboration⁴.

8 These legislative acts not only support more efficient and sustainable resource use, but also broader EU objectives. Most notably, they support European 'strategic autonomy'⁵, by strengthening supply chain security and increasing the domestic sourcing of materials. In particular, the Critical Raw Materials Act (2024) and the RESourceEU Action Plan (2025) respond to the need for a secure, sustainable supply of critical materials in the EU, complementing the other European measures related to the circular economy.

⁴ [EU-Circular-Economy-White-Paper-D-03-26.pdf](#)

⁵ [2025 State of the Union Address by President von der Leyen](#)

(b) The Ecodesign for Sustainable Products Regulation and the Digital Product Passport

- 9 The ESPR represents a crucial piece of legislation for achieving the circularity objectives specified by the European Green Deal. It provides the conceptual framework and specifies how ecodesign requirements will be introduced and implemented for almost all physical goods placed in the EU market⁶.

Building on previous legislations

- 10 The ESPR builds on previous commitments set by Directive 2009/125/EC on the Ecodesign requirements for Energy-related Products⁷ (EErP), focused on curbing inefficient energy use and increase energy efficiency, and the Energy Labelling Directive⁸, which was first introduced in 1994 and was amended in XXXX to cover all energy-related products (goods having an impact on energy consumption during use). Both legislations have been instrumental in setting the stage for the ESPR. For instance, the methodology devised for EErP specifications (namely, the MEErP⁹) specified how techno-economic-environmental assessments of product groups should be conducted, while the European Product Registry for Energy Labelling¹⁰ (EPREL) set up in 2017 proved how information about energy labels can be digitally stored and accessed by suppliers, consumers and national authorities.
- 11 The ESPR will ultimately replace the EErP in full, but there will be no gap: since the ESPR's entry into force in July 2024, a transition regime - lasting until 2030 - has been in place. This will enable the EErP to continue to operate, including implementing the Ecodesign and Energy Labelling Working Plan 2022-2024¹¹.

ESPR prescriptions and definitions

- 12 As per the ESPR, ecodesign requirements will be enacted at the product level through product-specific delegated acts¹². Importantly, as specified by the European Commission¹³,

⁶ Specific exclusions are food and feed, medicinal products for human and veterinary use, living plants and animals, products of human origin, and products of defence or national security interest, as well as some other categories. As explained in the Regulation, these categories were excluded since ecodesign requirements would not be effective in promoting their environmental sustainability and because other frameworks already provide for the setting of such requirements.

⁷ [Directive 2009/125/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council of 21 October 2009 establishing a framework for the setting of ecodesign requirements for energy-related products](#)

⁸ Commission Directive 94/2/EC of 21 January 1994 implementing Council Directive 92/75/EEC with regard to energy labelling of household electric refrigerators, freezers and their combinations

⁹ [Methodology \(MEErP\) - Energy Efficient Products - European Commission](#)

¹⁰ [EPREL Public website](#)

¹¹ [Communication from the Commission Ecodesign and Energy Labelling Working Plan 2022-2024 2022/C 182/01](#)

¹² 'Product-specific' is here intended as conceptual umbrella for three granularity levels: at 'model', at 'batch' or at 'item' level, based on the similarities and unique natures of what can be more generally considered as 'products'.

¹³ [Ecodesign for Sustainable Products and Energy Labelling Working Plan 2025-2030](#)

some products will be prioritised (i.e. iron & steel, aluminium, textiles, tyres, aluminium, furniture, mattresses and ICT) whilst others will be considered at a later stage. These ecodesign requirements will be based on existing industry practices and consultations with relevant stakeholders at each step, following a common methodology developed by the JRC¹⁴.

- 13 Relatedly, the ESPR introduces a vocabulary of definitions which will be used to describe the circular performance of products. All circularity metrics such as durability, reliability and recyclability are defined in Article 2: “Definitions”. This vocabulary provides the conceptual foundations for the future requirements of all products expected to be covered by the ESPR.
- 14 In Article 2, the ESPR distinguishes between two main types of ecodesign requirements: information and performance requirements, respectively defined in Article 7 and Article 6:
- (a) *Information requirements* indicate the obligation for a product to be accompanied by things such as instruction for use and repair, indications for disposal and any other information that could influence product choices for consumers and the way the product is handled.
 - (b) *Performance requirements* are quantitative or qualitative requirements for, or in relation to, a product to achieve a certain performance level based on a particular parameter (such parameters are listed in Annex 1).
 - (c) Moreover, the ESPR mentions that when requirements match across different product groups, the future ecodesign specifications could include ‘horizontal’ requirements to streamline and maximise their effectiveness.
- 15 Alongside the vocabulary of definitions, Article 5 describes the ‘product aspects’ that each set of requirements, if relevant, should cover for a specific product group. The list of product aspects can be found in [Appendix 1](#) of this Issue Paper.

Operationalising the ESPR: Digital Product Passports

- 16 Digital Product Passports (DPPs) will function as the primary mechanism for implementing and operationalising ESPR requirements in a digital format. For each product or product-specific category (see [footnote XX](#) for the meaning of ‘product’), the ESPR prescribes the drafting of a ‘specification’ with all the information required in that product’s DPP. DPP

¹⁴ [JRC Publications - Methodology for defining data requirements for the Digital Product Passport under the ESPR framework](#)

specifications are, in essence, the ecodesign requirements defined in practice for specific products, and will be published in product-specific delegated acts.

- 17 Building on the success of EPREL, DPPs will be registered and updated by EU manufacturers and will make information accessible for all economic actors throughout the value chain (i.e. other manufacturers, recyclers, distributors, consumers and authorities)¹⁵. Information will be accessible through a Web portal and, where possible, a data carrier (i.e. a QR code or barcode) attached to the packaging or the product itself, which gives access to a central registry of all the registered DPPs.
- 18 By linking product specifications with operator and facility identifiers, DPPs are also expected to enhance traceability of data along the value chain. In particular, DPPs will provide the necessary architecture for businesses to track materials and processes throughout the supply chain, offering a better understanding of how different actors influence the overall product lifecycle (e.g. through processing, manufacturing, transportation, end-of-life). This centralised data flow will improve information sharing between actors in the value chain, supporting both bilateral trade and sustainable production practices.
- 19 To achieve this level of traceability, the ESPR demands a considerable volume of data exchange across the entire value chain. Since the regulation applies to economic operators placing products on the EU market, regardless of whether they are EU-based or SMEs, the total administrative influx of data will be significant.
- 20 The JRC Methodological paper explicitly acknowledges the potential risk of creating an unfair burden particularly on SMEs, through the unnecessary duplication of data collection and reporting. To mitigate this risk, the JRC actively evaluates the existence of other EU legislation to identify opportunities for data reuse. When developing product-specific specifications, the JRC will use a foundational screening question designed to ensure cross-regulatory efficiency: *‘Do any proposed DPP data elements duplicate, overlap with, or could be derived from information required under other Union legislation, and is the mapping between these datasets clearly defined?’*.
- 21 This specific question provides the regulatory mandate needed to align the ESPR with the corporate-level reporting on the ESRS. By asking whether DPP data can be derived from or mapped to existing Union frameworks, the JRC has established a clear pathway for correspondence. For preparers, this means the extensive product data collected for a DPP

¹⁵ Different access rights’ will be set for the various economic actors to preserve confidentiality of information.

can be systematically channelled upward to satisfy the broader corporate disclosure requirements of ESRS E5, preventing duplicate reporting streams and streamlining compliance across both frameworks. The following sections will highlight this connection in greater detail.

How the CSRD and the ESRS fit into the picture

- 22 The CSRD, similarly to the ESPR, sets the premises and prescriptions for corporate sustainability data requirements, requiring companies to disclose detailed ESG information based on shared reporting standards (i.e. the ESRS).
- 23 After EFRAG's publication of ESRS in 2023, 'Wave-1' companies in the scope of the CSRD had already started to collect ESG data and report it in their sustainability reports.
- 24 Of most relevance to this issue paper is 'ESRS E5 – Resource use and Circular Economy', which prescribes disclosure requirements concerning resource inflows and outflows, including product-level, circularity metrics (ESRS E5-5 Resource outflows).
- 25 Following the publication of the Omnibus I Simplification Package by the European Commission, EFRAG resumed its mandate on March 27, 2026, to deliver technical advice on ESRS simplification. This initiative aimed to reduce administrative burdens associated with sustainability reporting, whilst upholding the objectives of the EU Green Deal.
- 26 The revision process focused on removing unnecessary data points, prioritizing quantitative over narrative disclosures, favouring mandatory over voluntary datapoints, providing clear guidance through application requirements, and ensuring both interoperability and consistency with other EU legislation.
- 27 Aligning with existing European legislative acts was critical. Because the ESRS function as Level 2 regulations, they are designed to complement, rather than duplicate or contradict, primary EU legislation. Consequently, when drafting the 'Simplified ESRS E5 – Resource Use and Circular Economy', the EFRAG Secretariat paid particular attention to alignment with frameworks such as the WFD, R2R, CMA and ESPR.
- 28 To better understand how the requirements in the simplified ESRS E5 interact with broader EU policy, the following section evaluates whether definitions between the ESRS and the ESPR correspond, and to what extent ESRS disclosures may support or leverage future DPP requirements.

(c) Correspondence between ESRS E5 and ESPR

29 This section explores the areas of correspondence between the ESRS E5 and ESPR, and assesses their broader regulatory implications, with a high-level overview of how the systems interact followed by a deep dive into the specific alignment of their definitions.

High-level correspondence

30 While both frameworks serve as critical pillars of the EU Green Deal's circular economy strategy, they differ fundamentally in their regulatory approach, scope, and implementation timelines.

31 To situate this comparative analysis within the broader landscape of EU policy, the following table maps the distinct structural features of both frameworks. It compares their regulatory nature, objectives, scopes, and implementation timelines, illustrating how they approach the circular transition from different angles.

32 Crucially, it highlights that while the ESPR remains a specialized, product-level environmental tool, ESRS E5 belongs to a comprehensive, sector-agnostic suite of corporate standards designed to capture the entire spectrum of Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) performance.

Feature	ESRS E5 (under the CSRD)	ESPR
General overview	Organization-level transparency and disclosure standard. It is part of a broad, sector-agnostic framework that comprehensively environmental, social and governance topics.	Product-level behavioural and performance regulation.
Primary objective	To provide investors and other stakeholders with comparable, macro-level corporate sustainability data.	To ensure products placed on the EU market are durable, repairable, energy-efficient, and circular.
Primary obligation	Public disclosure of circular economy strategies, metrics, and material impacts within the Management Report.	Compliance with binding ecodesign criteria and the creation of a Digital Product Passport (DPP).
Scope	Applies to all large companies operating in the EU (based on headcount and turnover).	Applies to almost all physical goods placed on the EU market, regardless of the manufacturer's size and origin.
Timeline	Gradual rollout for companies, which began in FY2024.	The framework has been enacted, but specific obligations will take effect gradually as product-specific Delegated Acts are adopted.

Flexibility	Allows companies to determine what is "key" or "material" based on a corporate double materiality assessment.	Imposes strict, non-negotiable thresholds and parameters once a product's Delegated Act is active.
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Correspondence of definition

- 33 A comparison of the ‘product aspects’ defined in the ESPR reveals similarities with metrics required by ESRS E5-5 (Resource outflows) (see [Appendix 1](#)), particularly on topics like durability, reusability, repairability and recyclability.
- 34 Within ESRS E5, metrics are defined at a general level without prescribing sector or product-specific metrics, thereby granting companies a degree of flexibility in their reporting. For example, a clothing manufacturer may report ‘quantitative and/or qualitative information on the expected durability’ (ESRS E5-5 paragraph 15(a)) of its sweatshirts through a disclosure of ‘abrasion resistance’, whereas another company might report on the same requirement using ‘washing cycles’.
- 35 The ESPR operates on a similar logic; it establishes the overarching conceptual framework while leaving sector or product-specific metrics to be defined in upcoming Delegated Acts.
- 36 The table below compares how the concepts of durability, repairability, recyclability, and reusability are defined across the different frameworks.
- 37 The first column provides the metric name, the second column includes its definition according to the EFRAG Glossary of Terms (Annex II), the third column displays the corresponding definition under Article 2 of the ESPR and the fourth column provides an analytical commentary on the relationship between the two definitions.

Metric name	ESRS (Annex II)	ESPR (Article 2)	Comment
Durability	The ability of a product, component or material to remain functional and relevant under specified conditions of use, maintenance and repair, until the technical end of life. Durability often refers to the physical capacity of a product to resist wear, damage, or degradation, but it can also encompass technological durability, for instance, the ability to remain effective through software updates.	Ability of a product to maintain over time its function and performance under specified conditions of use, maintenance and repair.	Both frameworks focus on maintaining functionality under normal conditions of use and repair. However, the ESRS definition explicitly introduces technological durability (e.g., software updates) and relevance, making it slightly more future-proof for digital/electronic products than the baseline ESPR text.
Repairability	Product's ability to be restored to a functional state through the availability of spare parts over its entire possible life span, the simplicity of disassembly, and the accessibility of repair information.	One or more actions carried out to return a defective product or waste to a condition where it fulfils its intended purpose.	The ESRS defines repairability as an inherent design characteristic of the product (disassembly, spare parts, info access). In contrast, the ESPR definition focuses on the action of repairing rather than the ease of doing so. However, the JRC methodology bridges this gap by defining 'recyclability' as the '<i>ease with which a product can be restored to working order</i>', thereby mirroring the ESRS focus on inherent design characteristics. Furthermore, the DPPs are foreseen to enhance how repairability will be performed in practice: use cases could range from links to suppliers' location, to

			dedicated videos where repair is demonstrated first-hand, and even AI features where users could take photos of the broken part and receive a tailored answer ¹⁶ .
Recyclability	The ESRS do not define ‘recyclability’ per se but ‘ <i>Designed Recyclability Rate</i> ’ as: an indicator which measures the share of the resource outflow that is designed and manufactured in such a way that it can be processed into recycled material. It can be demonstrated by, for example, the use of materials that are fully recyclable with existing recycling schemes, selection of fewer material types and increased material homogeneity, ability to dismantle the product or the suitability of the product parts and materials for recycling into high quality materials and the implementation of adequate guidelines for design for recycling for the product type. The rate indicates how the product and used materials can be	No definition provided in the ESPR. From the JRC Methodology: ‘How well a product’s materials can be recovered as high quality recycle at end of life’.	Within the ESRS E5 framework, recyclability is evaluated through two distinct operational lenses: the designed recyclability rate for products and packaging (para. 15(c)) and the actual recycling rate within waste recovery operations (para.16(c)). The application architecture for the <i>designed recyclability rate</i> is established in Application Requirement 3 (AR 3) for paragraph 15(c), which provides the equation which the undertaking must use to calculate the designed recyclability rate of their key products and packaging. The equation is as follow: (a) <i>For products:</i> $\text{Designed recyclability rate} = \frac{\text{total weight of recyclable materials incorporated in the product}_x}{\text{total weight of the product}_x} \times 100$ (b) <i>for packaging:</i>

¹⁶ These examples are provided in the JRC Methodology.

	recycled by an existing recycling scheme and that ‘use phase’ does not significantly change the recyclability (e.g. contamination).		<i>Designed recyclability rate</i> $= \frac{\text{total weight of recyclable materials incorporated in the packaging}_x}{\text{total weight of the packaging}_x}$ × 100
Recycling	Any recovery operation by which waste materials are reprocessed into products, materials or substances whether for the original or other purposes. It includes the reprocessing of organic material but does not include energy recovery and the reprocessing into materials that are to be used as fuels or for backfilling operations (see Waste Framework Directive (2008/98/EC)).	While the JRC Methodology for the DPP specifications stays broad, the ESPR references the Waste Framework Directive for defining recyclability.	These equations are drawn from ISO 59020 (2024) (<i>Circular economy — Measuring and assessing circularity performance</i>). The ISO standard notes that the designed recyclability rate is ‘<i>based on the design for recycling as intended by the manufacturer</i>’, even though it is ‘<i>not a substitute for the per cent actual recycled material derived from an outflow</i>’. Such remarks hint to an <i>ex-ante</i> (potential) calculation of the metric by the manufacturer, evaluating what is technically possible by design, independent from the actual recycling done in practice. To balance this indicator, the ESRS also features an <i>ex-post</i> (actual) metric under paragraph 16(c). This requires undertakings to disclose the proportion of waste diverted from disposal, including the proportion of waste sent to recycling operations. The baseline definition of recycling here is drawn directly from the Waste Framework Directive. Through this dual-metric approach, the ESRS captures both potential recyclability and actual recycling.

			In comparison, the ESPR relies on the baseline definition of recycling provided by the Waste Framework Directive, explicitly clarifying the inclusions (e.g. reprocessing of organic material) and exclusions (e.g. energy recovery operations)
Reusability	The ESRS do not define 'reusability' per se but 'reuse' as: any operation by which products or components of products that are not waste are used again for the same purpose for which they were conceived. This may involve cleaning or small adjustments, so it is ready for the next use without significant pre-processing.	Definition for 're-use' points to the Waste Framework Directive. Article 3 (13) of the WFD defines re-use as 'any operation by which products or components that are not waste are used again for the same purpose for which they were conceived'	Both frameworks omit a standalone definition for 'reusability' but share a common definition for 'reuse', derived from the Waste Framework Directive. The ESRS text simply adds practical, operational examples (cleaning, small adjustments) to guide corporate disclosure, ensuring minimal friction between reporting under CSRD and complying with ESPR obligations.

Additional information

- 38 While these shared definitions create a strong conceptual bridge, translating them into day-to-day operations reveals a significant structural disconnect regarding what constitutes a ‘key materials’ or ‘key products’ under ESRS E5.
- 39 According to ESRS Annex II – Acronyms and glossary of terms¹⁷, an undertaking identifies its key products and materials through a ‘structured managerial assessment’. This process considers both internal factors (such as a materials or product’s contribution to revenues, profitability, innovation, or operational continuity) and external factors (including environmental or social impacts such as stakeholder perceptions, regulatory demands or reputational significance).
- 40 In ESRS E5, pinpointing what is ‘key’ is a critical prerequisite for disclosure, as it allows undertakings to streamline their reporting, focusing exclusively on the materials and products essential to their ongoing operations and impacts.
- 41 In contrast, the ESPR operates on a product-level mandate, rather than a company-level one. Under the ESPR, an undertaking will eventually be required to maintain a DPP for each of its products that falls within the scope of the upcoming product-specific Delegated Acts, regardless of its materiality at a corporate or managerial level.
- 42 This creates a complex operational reality for corporate preparers. A company may find itself legally mandated to build intricate data collection systems and DPPs for minor product lines under the ESPR, while its core ESRS E5 sustainability statement will focus on a different set of ‘key products’, deemed material at the group level.
- 43 Additionally, because of the piecemeal release of ESPR requirements, certain products will have ESPR requirements sooner than others. Therefore, when a preparer reports against ESRS, depending on its key products, it will / will not have an existing data ecosystem, generated through the ESPR.

(d) Significance of the DPP for ESRS E5 reporting

- 44 As established above, the ESRS and the ESPR share a common conceptual foundation rooted in harmonized definitions. Beyond this baseline alignment, the two frameworks operate synergistically, actively reinforcing and influencing one another in practice.
- 45 Undertakings within the scope of the CSRD may already possess a structural advantage, as their existing data collection processes for compliance with ESRS E5 cover the core pillars

¹⁷ Source: <https://www.efrag.org/en/draft-simplified-esrs>.

of durability, recyclability, and reusability. However, the ESRS are, at this stage, sector-agnostic corporate reporting requirements. They do not mandate specific, uniform metrics or targets at the individual product level, meaning they function as transparency tools rather than behavioural or prescriptive performance standards.

- 46 On the other hand, the product-level mandates of the ESPR can be directly leveraged to fulfil this corporate disclosure. Companies subject to both frameworks can streamline their reporting by incorporating DPP information by reference.
- 47 Under ESRS 1 [par. 119 a](#), an undertaking may incorporate external information by reference when it *‘constitutes a separate element of information clearly identified in the source document as addressing the relevant ESRS DR or datapoint’*. This provision grants significant operational flexibility, allowing companies to embed a direct link to the Web portal of registered DPPs within their sustainability report, thereby preventing duplicative disclosures and reducing administrative burdens.
- 48 This mechanism of incorporation by reference is highly valuable, not only for quantitative metrics but also for providing context required for ESRS E5 policies. Specifically, ESRS E5 [par. 9](#) states that *‘if the undertaking integrates circular economy principles or eco-design requirements in its key products and circular economy services, it shall explain how this is done’*. The granular data within the DPP provides the exact technical evidence needed to satisfy this requirement. Similarly, product-level ecodesign specifications can serve as a concrete benchmark to track the progress of broader corporate circular economy targets, which must be reported under ESRS 2 [GDR-T](#).
- 49 Providing verified ecodesign data via an official registered DPP also improves the auditability of corporate sustainability reports. Independent assurance providers gain a straightforward mechanism to verify the provenance of a company’s circular economy claims. Crucially, this audit trail extends beyond EU borders, allowing auditors to efficiently verify the compliance and sustainability profiles of products manufactured outside the Union.
- 50 Ultimately, the synergy between these two framework drives significant traceability across value chains. By embedding the product-specific, bottom-up data of the DPP into the corporate reporting architecture of ESRS E5, preparers are equipped with the granular insights needed to identify, manage and disclose more precise circularity impacts, risks and opportunities (IROs).

Appendix 1: ‘product aspects’ as defined by the ESPR

Introduction

- 1 The reason for this appendix.

The details

- 2 Quoting ESPR Article 5 comma 1: “the ecodesign requirements in the delegated acts ... shall be such as to improve the following product aspects (‘product aspects’) where those product aspects are relevant to the product group concerned:

- (a) **durability***
- (b) reliability
- (c) **reusability****
- (d) upgradability
- (e) **repairability*****
- (f) the possibility of maintenance and refurbishment
- (g) the presence of substances of concern
- (h) energy use and energy efficiency
- (i) water use and water efficiency
- (j) resource use and resource efficiency
- (k) recycled content
- (l) the possibility of remanufacturing
- (m) **recyclability******
- (n) the possibility of the recovery of materials
- (o) environmental impacts, including carbon footprint and environmental footprint
- (p) expected generation of waste”

***durability** is mentioned in [E5-5 par. 15 \(a\)](#)

****reusability** is mentioned in [E5-5 par. 16 \(c\) \(i\)](#)

*****repairability** is mentioned in [E5-5 par. 15 \(b\)](#)

******recyclability** is mentioned in [E5-5 par. 15 \(c\)](#)

ESPR Product Aspect (Article 5, 1)	Relevant ESRS topical disclosure requirement	Relevant ESRS paragraph(s)	Additional information
durability	E5-1; E5-5	9., 15. (a)	
reliability	n/a	n/a	Not mentioned in ESRS E5
reusability	E5-1; E5-5	9., 16. (c)	
upgradability	E5-1	9.	See Annex II definition of 'eco-design requirement'
repairability	E5-1; E5-5	15. (b)	
the possibility of maintenance and refurbishment	E5-1	9.	See Annex II definition of 'eco-design requirement'
the presence of substances of concern	E2-5	17.	Not disclosed at product-level
energy use and energy efficiency	E1-7	25. (a)-(c)	Not disclosed at product-level
water use and water efficiency	E3-4	15. (a)-(f)	Not disclosed at product-level
resource use and resource efficiency	E5-4	13(a)-(d)	Key materials, critical and strategic raw materials, secondary resources used
recycled content	E5-1; E5-5	9., 15. (c)	
the possibility of remanufacturing	E5-1	9.	See Annex II definition of 'eco-design requirement'
recyclability	E5-5	15. (c)	<i>'Designed recyclability rate'</i>
the possibility of the recovery of materials	E5-5	16. (c)	the proportion of waste diverted from disposal

environmental impacts, including carbon footprint and environmental footprint	E1-8	28., 29. (a)-(c), 30.	Not disclosed at product-level
expected generation of waste	E5-5	16. (a)-(e), 17.	Waste from own operations, diverted from disposal, directed to disposal, final destination unknown, radioactive waste